

ARCHITECTURE OF GRACE · CONFIDENTIAL — FOR FAMILY
REVIEW



The Architecture of Grace

BOOK FIVE · THE CAPSTONE

Home Edition

FOR FAMILIES · GRADES 11-12

The complete year-long curriculum — every lesson,
undiluted — re-engineered for delivery by a parent at
home, one conversation at a time.

FREE PREVIEW

This free preview includes the parent's opening letter, how to use the book, the
crisis & safety quick-reference, and the first complete lesson — read it end to end.
The full 4 units · 28 lessons are available in the Store.

Before You Begin

A letter to the parent of a child in grades 3, 4, or 5

This is the final book — the Capstone, the grades 11–12 year, and the close of the entire Architecture of Grace journey. It hands you the whole curriculum, **nothing simplified, nothing left out**. But the register here is different: your child is a near-adult, months from leaving the structured world of school for one with far less scaffolding. Your role has almost finished its shift — from teacher, to consultant, to something closer to a fellow adult thinking out loud beside them.

This year is about what they carry across the threshold: a moral compass they've actually examined, an honest reckoning with their own past, forgiveness deep enough to set down old weight, and a sense of the legacy they're beginning to plant. For autistic young adults, the stakes are especially concrete — the move out of school often means losing supports (an IEP, a counselor, a predictable routine) just as life gets less structured. This book is, quietly, survival-equipment for that transition: self-advocacy, mental-health literacy, and sustainable systems for a life that has to run for decades, not semesters.

WHAT WE NEED TO TELL YOU — DIRECTLY

This book contains the three highest-risk lessons in the entire K–12 curriculum — and the transition to adulthood is itself a high-risk window, sharply so for autistic young adults, who face elevated rates of depression, anxiety, and suicidal thinking as supports fall away. Distress at this age can hide behind competence and 'I'm fine.' If your near-adult signals — in words, writing, or behavior — that they don't want to be here, or that the future feels impossible, take it seriously the first time, every time. Don't debate it. Get help. 988 (call or text) is always available.

A few things this book asks of you:

- ◆ **Meet them as the adult they're becoming.** Lectures land worst now. Offer these as questions between two people who respect each other. Their right to self-determination is no longer negotiable — it's the point.
- ◆ **Take the transition cliff seriously.** Losing school's structure and supports at once is genuinely destabilizing for an autistic young adult. Help them build the scaffolding — routines, supports, named people — before they need it, not after it collapses.
- ◆ **Independence doesn't mean alone.** The goal isn't a young adult who needs no one — it's one who knows how to find and accept support. Interdependence, not isolation. Mental-health literacy and 'who do I call' are core adult skills, not weaknesses.
- ◆ **A sustainable life beats an impressive one.** 'Can I run on this for twenty years?' matters more than any achievement. For an autistic adult, a self-determined, lower-demand, genuinely restorative life isn't settling — it's how you avoid burning out by thirty.
- ◆ **When a lesson is bigger than you — say so.** These are the heaviest lessons in the whole curriculum. "This one's big. Let's bring in your counselor." models exactly what the book teaches: that asking for help is an adult strength.

ONE MORE THING

You are nearly done raising them, and that's its own grief. You won't get every conversation right, and you don't have to. You have been the architecture under them this whole time. What you're doing now is helping them become their own. You are reading this. You are still showing up. That is the work — right to the end.

ORIENTATION

How to Use This Book

A flip book — one complete lesson per spread, in any order you like

There are **28 lessons** across 4 units, mirroring the final school year. Order matters less than presence — open to a lesson, read it once, and let it surface in real conversation. At this age the best exchanges happen as equals: a late-night kitchen talk, a long drive, a 'what do you actually think about this?' — never a summoned lecture.

Every lesson is built from the same six parts — once you know the shape of one, you know all 28:

① CORE DIRECT INSTRUCTION — HOME DELIVERY

The actual school lesson — objective, concepts, and steps intact — rewritten for one child and one adult at home, in real conversation rather than a scheduled block.

② THE AUTISM LENS

Three fixed supports: Make It Literal & Concrete, Sensory Regulation (matched to the lesson's emotional load), and Universal Design for Communication — so the lesson works whether your child speaks, types, uses AAC, points, or draws.

③ ELITE CONVERSATION STARTERS

Low-pressure, one-question prompts tagged to the natural moments of a day — each paired with a script to model on yourself first.

④ PRINTABLE VISUAL ASSETS & CHARTS

Ready-to-print anchor charts and home tools — fridge-and-binder versions of the classroom's visuals.

▲ SAFETY & ESCALATION

On every lesson: a clear line for when to bring in a professional. On high-stakes lessons this band grows — and tells you plainly when a conversation belongs to your child's counselor, not to you alone.

✦ PARENT REFLECTION

One private question after each lesson. Not homework. A place to put what the lesson stirred up — because it will.

IF YOU ONLY HAVE THREE MINUTES

Read the Crisis & Safety page next — it matters most in this book. Then read Lesson 1 (The Exit Interview) and Unit 2, Lesson 4 (The Sustainable Soul). Those three pages frame the whole year: who they're becoming, and whether the life they're building can actually last.

QUICK REFERENCE · KEEP THIS PAGE VISIBLE

If You Need Help Right Now

Crisis & safety numbers — fill in the local line before you ever need it

988	Suicide & Crisis Lifeline — call or text · 24/7 · free
741741	Crisis Text Line — text HOME · for when speaking isn't possible
911	Immediate danger. If you can, ask for a CIT-trained officer and say your child is autistic.
—	Your local mobile crisis line — write it here now: _____

A NOTE ON CALLING 911

Police interactions can be dangerous for autistic people if officers are not trained. When possible, call mobile crisis, your pediatrician, or 988 first. Reserve 911 for immediate physical danger.

FOR THE PARENT OF AN AUTISTIC CHILD

In the 3–5 years, distress often shows as withdrawal, shutdown, somatic complaints, or a sudden change — not the words “I feel sad.” Watch the whole child. When in doubt, ask your pediatrician or counselor. You are never overreacting by checking.

UNIT ONE



The Compass of Integrity • Moral Foundations

Adulthood demands a moral compass you’ve actually examined — not inherited rules. Unit 1 opens with an Exit Interview (who have I been; who am I becoming), maps where values truly come from, tests them under fire and in adult institutions, grounds them in the science of moral development, and names the Moral North Star: the single principle that makes all your values coherent.

AUGUST – OCTOBER • SEVEN LESSONS

UNIT 1 • LESSON 1 • HOME EDITION

The Exit Interview STANDARD

A structured self-examination: who have I been — and who am I choosing to become?

OBJECTIVE

Your near-adult conducts an Exit Interview with themselves — naming who they’ve been, what they’re releasing, carrying forward, and choosing to build.

CASEL FOCUS

Self-Awareness — identity synthesis at a threshold

VOCABULARY

exit interview · release · carry forward · build ·
character vs. résumé

AT HOME

50–55 min · August · First lesson of the final year

① Core Direct Instruction — Home Delivery

- 1 **THE PREMISE · 8 MIN** “You’re about to leave one chapter for a much bigger one. Companies do exit interviews when someone leaves — honest reflection on what was, and what’s next. Today you do one with yourself: Who have I been in these years? Who am I choosing to become?”
- 2 **RÉSUMÉ VS. CHARACTER · 7 MIN** “Most people can list their achievements. Far fewer can describe their character development. Your applications ask for the first thing. The Exit Interview asks for the second — and that’s the harder, truer question.”
- 3 **THREE COLUMNS · 15 MIN** Privately: “What am I **releasing** — an identity that no longer serves me? What am I **carrying forward**? What am I **choosing to build**?” The hardest is usually ‘releasing’ — especially an identity they’ve been praised for.
- 4 **SIT WITH IT · 5 MIN** “The work isn’t to condemn who you’ve been. It’s to ask, honestly: does this still serve who I’m becoming?”

② The Autism Lens

◆ **Make It Literal & Concrete** The **three-column structure (release / carry forward / build)** makes **identity-transition a concrete, sortable task** rather than an overwhelming ‘who are you?’ For a near-adult who thinks in systems, framing the leap as a structured exit interview gives it shape and lowers the threat.

◆ **Sensory Regulation — tied to this theme** This first lesson sets the register for the year — keep it calm, unhurried, and genuinely two-way. For autistic young adults the transition out of school is huge and can be terrifying; an identity they’ve been praised for (‘the smart one,’ ‘the one who copes’) may be a hard one to examine releasing. Don’t push the ‘release’ column. The Exit Interview can surface real anxiety about leaving — watch the Safety band.

◆ **Universal Design for Communication** **Write, type, or talk through** the three columns; it’s private, never required to share. A teen can fill just one column. Any modality.

③ Elite Conversation Starters

LONG DRIVE “If you did an honest exit interview on these years — what are you releasing, keeping, and building?”

KITCHEN, LATE “Who do you want to **become** — not what do you want to **do**? Different question, isn’t it?”

MODELING “When I left my twenties, the identity I had to release was ‘the person who says yes to everything.’ What’s yours?”

PARENT SCRIPT — MODEL IT ON YOURSELF

“When I hit a big transition, my own exit interview was clarifying and uncomfortable. Carrying forward: my stubbornness about fairness. Building: more patience. **Releasing** — the hardest — was the identity of ‘the one who never needs help.’ I’d been praised for it for years. It wasn’t serving me anymore. What’s in your three columns?”

④ Printable Visual Assets & Charts

THE EXIT INTERVIEW

**THE ‘RELEASING’ COLUMN IS USUALLY THE HARDEST RELEASE WHAT NO LONGER SERVES ME
CARRY FORWARD WHAT I KEEP BUILD WHO I’M CHOOSING TO BECOME**

Your applications ask what you **achieved**. The Exit Interview asks who you became.

▲ SAFETY & ESCALATION

This first Capstone lesson asks for honest self-examination, which for some near-adults surfaces real distress — about leaving, about who they’ve been, about an uncertain future. Keep the tone calm and respectful of their adulthood. If reflection turns to hopelessness about the future or themselves, set the worksheet aside and talk; involve your counselor if needed. Keep 988 visible. This is a sensitive topic; if your young adult is struggling, professional support can help.

✦ PARENT REFLECTION

What is my near-adult choosing to release, carry, and build — and what does the ‘release’ column reveal about who they’ve had to be? Does leaving feel exciting to them, or frightening?

END OF FREE PREVIEW

That was Lesson 1 of 4 units • 28 lessons.

The free preview ends here — you've just read the parent's letter, the orientation, the crisis & safety reference, and the first complete lesson, exactly as a family would use it at the kitchen table. The rest of the year continues in the same shape: one complete lesson per spread, in any order you like.

- ◆ Every lesson built from the same six parts — once you know one, you know them all.
- ◆ The Autism Lens on every lesson: Make It Literal, Sensory Regulation, and Universal Design for Communication.
- ◆ Elite conversation starters tagged to the real moments of a day — each with a script to model first.
- ◆ Printable anchor charts and home tools, plus a Safety & Escalation band and a Parent Reflection on every lesson.

Take it home.

The complete The Capstone Home Edition — all 4 units • 28 lessons, undiluted — is available in the Store. A check-in, not an exam; a curriculum, not a worksheet.